LaTeX with Overleaf + AI: Prerequisites

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Do these three things before the session

Everything in the session runs in a web browser, so you do not have to install anything.

- [ ] Bring a laptop with a recent browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), its charger, and working internet. A phone or tablet is not enough for typing code.
- [ ] Create a free account at overleaf.com.
- [ ] Have a login for any one AI assistant you already use, such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot. The free tier is enough.

Five-minute check

If this test produces a PDF, you are ready for the session.

1. Log in to Overleaf and choose New Project, then Blank Project. Name it "Session test".
2. Delete everything in `main.tex` and paste the five lines below.
3. Press Recompile, or Ctrl+Enter (Cmd+Enter on a Mac).
4. The PDF on the right should show the heading "1 Test" and one line containing a formula.

```
\documentclass{article}
\begin{document}
\section{Test}
It works: $E = mc^2$.
\end{document}
```

If you get a red error instead, leave it as it is and bring it to the session. Reading errors is one of the topics.

Bring these files for the exercise

The hands-on exercise builds a one-page paper from your own material.

- [ ] One image file (PNG or JPG), such as a plot or a diagram.
- [ ] A small table of data with 3 to 5 rows, in Excel or copied from a paper.
- [ ] One paper or book you would cite, with its Google Scholar page open.
- [ ] Optional: a page of your own notes or an assignment that you want to typeset.

What you do not need

The session starts from zero, so none of these is required:

- Previous experience with LaTeX or programming.
- A paid Overleaf plan or a paid AI subscription.
- Any installed software: LaTeX, the diagrams and the AI tools all run inside Overleaf.

If a step on this sheet does not work, take a screenshot and bring it to the session.